Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on May 10, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair - Councillor	A. Khan
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	L. Bower
		R. Tyler Morin
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Khan called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on April 12, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on April 12, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.5 and 4.7 for discussion.

Moved by: S. Lee

That items 4.4, 4.6, 4.8 and 4.9 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 CAO-2021-06: Council Expense Policy Update

Committee Members asked questions regarding constraints on reallocating budgeted spending amounts between expense categories, clothing allowance, expense entitlements for Mayor and Members of Council, promotional and marketing materials, content management and design supports, branding and marketing materials, use of corporate resources for election purposes, and reporting requirements. Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer and Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Council Expense Policy be approved.

CARRIED

4.2 FIN-2021-02: 2020 Federal Gas Tax Funding – Annual Report and 2021 Top-up Allocation

Members had no questions or comments regarding this matter.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report “2020 Federal Gas Tax Funding – Annual Report and 2021 Top-up Allocation” be received for information.

2. That the 2021 Gas Tax funding top-up be allocated to capital projects identified through the 2022 capital budget process.

CARRIED

4.3 FIN-2021-08: Annual Investment Report – January 1, 2020 to December 31, 2020

Committee Members asked questions regarding investment options, banking fees, the banking agreement renewal process, justifications for procuring a dedicated investment staff member, timelines to develop investment strategies and update the Town’s Investment Policy, and risk tolerance levels. D. Valentim, Sandra Serrao, Manager of Budgets and Accounting Services, and S. Baker responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the Annual Investment Report for the period January 1 to December 31, 2020 be received for information.

2. That Staff be authorized to resume investments as deemed appropriate by the Treasurer in accordance with the current Investment Policy;

3. That Staff be directed to procure assistance to review and develop Investment Strategies and update the Town's Investment Policy.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That recommendation #2 be deleted; and

2. That recommendation #3 be amended to read as follows:

   That Staff be authorized to procure contract assistance for 6 months to assist with developing an RFP to investment firms to develop Investment Strategies and update the Town's Investment Policy.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the Annual Investment Report for the period January 1 to December 31, 2020 be received for information; and

2. That Staff be authorized to procure contract assistance for 6 months to assist with developing an RFP to investment firms to develop Investment Strategies and update the Town's Investment Policy.

CARRIED

4.4 FIN-2021-06: Capital Account Closing Report, December 31, 2020

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council receive the attached listing of Capital Account Closings as of December 31, 2020 for information.

2. That funding transfers to/from the Reserves / Reserve Funds from the December 31, 2020 Capital Account Closings, in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan, be approved as follows:

Reserve / Reserve Fund	Transfers to	Transfers from	Net Amounts
Capital Contingency Reserve	($17,956.59)	$351,932.94	$333,976.35

Building Maintenance Reserve	($269,016.59)	$31,818.04	($237,198.55)
Storm Water Reserve	($51,852.13)		($51,852.13)
General Infrastructure Reserve	($148,485.94)	$6,681.47	($141,804.47)
Federal Gas Tax Reserve		$10,835.96	$10,835.96
2018 DC Reserve Fund		$28,527.98	$28,527.98
Strategic Initiatives Reserve	($194,322.34)		($194,322.34)
Vehicle/Equipment Replacement Reserve	($63,799.07)	$23,057.71	($40,741.36)
Development Reserve	($16,609.23)	$40,600.94	$23,991.71
Total Transfers	**($762,041.89)**	**$493,455.04**	**($268,586.85)**

CARRIED

4.5 **FIN-2021-07: 2020 Operating Results and Year-End Reserve Allocations**

Committee Members asked questions regarding projected surplus / deficit and methods to ensure the most accurate projections at budget time, requirements to repay COVID-19 funding, motor vehicle accident reporting, expenditures attributed to COVID-19 impacts, stabilization reserve requirements under the Financial Sustainability Plan, and reserve allocation options and justifications. D. Valentim, Dave Lang, Fire Chief, and S. Baker responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report on the 2020 Operating Results be received for information.

2. That Council approve the following 2020 Year End Allocations to Reserves, as recommended by the Director of Finance in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan:

Reserve	Allocation
Stabilization Reserve	$ 1,386,506.38
Capital Contingency Reserve	$ 1,838,844.58
Stormwater Management Reserve	$ 300,000.00

CARRIED

4.6 **LIS-2021-04: 2020 Accessibility Plan Status Update**

Moved by: S. Lee

That the 2020 Accessibility Plan Status Update (ATT-1) be received for information.

CARRIED

4.7 **PDS-2021-23: Automated Speed Enforcement Project Scope Change and Award of Contract - Community Safety Zones Radar Message Boards**

Committee Members discussed the change of project scope and installation of speed boards in community safety zones.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council approve the change in scope to the capital account 1014411 - Automated Speed Enforcement, allowing the available budget to be utilized for the procurement of 12 Radar Message Boards for the deployment in the Town's Community Safety Zones as part of site preparation work associated with the Town's future Automated Speed Enforcement Program.

2. That Council award the contract for the procurement of 12 radar message boards to Signalizations Kalitec in the amount of $33,967.90 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

4.8 PDS-2021-24: 2021 Downtown Ajax Business Improvement Area (BIA) Budget and Tax Levy

Moved by: S. Lee

That Council approve the 2021 Downtown Ajax Business Improvement Area (BIA) annual budget in the amount of $27,430.00.

CARRIED

4.9 PDS-2021-25: 2021 Pickering Village Business Improvement Area (BIA) Budget and Tax Levy

Moved by: S. Lee

That Council approve the 2021 Pickering Village Business Improvement Area (BIA) annual budget in the amount of $50,000.00.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

6. Presentations

6.1 Town's Hiring Practices

Mary Lou Cosentino, Manager of Human Resource Services, delivered a presentation regarding the Town's inclusive hiring practices. M. Cosentino discussed objectives, diversity in the workplace, benefits of a diverse and inclusive workplace, the Town's hiring principles, recruitment and hiring obligations, new hiring practices, new selection processes, and workplace diversity short-term and long-term initiatives.

Committee Members asked questions regarding timelines for completion of workplace diversity initiatives, census rollout and process, differences between existing hiring processes and proposed hiring processes, and requirements for criminal record checks. M. Cosentino, Natasha Sharma, Diversity & Inclusion Coordinator, and C. McLardie responded to questions from Committee Members.

6.2 PDS-2021-22: Textile Diversion Program

Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. C. Richardson reviewed the consultation process, Region of Durham's long-term waste management plan, where textile donations go, the 5R's hierarchy, ghost bins (illegal dumping), Town of Ajax clean community by-law, collection agencies, charitable collection agencies, five-phase implementation plan, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding program efficiencies, collection bin locations, education and communication strategies, and concerns related to ghost bins. C. Richardson responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: J. Dies

1. That Council approve the proposed implementation plan and corresponding actions to achieve a Town of Ajax Textile Diversion Program; and

2. That Council endorse a Council Charter on Textile Waste Reduction to showcase leadership as part of a community outreach strategy.

CARRIED

Closed Session (3:17 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session (3:17 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (c) (d) and (e) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss a matter pertaining to labour relations or employee negotiations, a proposed or pending acquisition or disposition of land by the municipality or local board, and litigation or potential litigation, including matters before administrative tribunals, affecting the municipality or local board.

CARRIED

7.1 **Collective Bargaining Council Update – CUPE Local 54**

7.2 **Central Park Ajax Matters**

7.3 **Hunt Street Acquisition Plan**

Open Meeting (4:35 p.m.)

7.3 **Hunt Street Acquisition Plan**

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That staff be directed to undertake a Detailed Feasibility Study to confirm the preferred routing option for the Hunt Street extension, to be funded from the capital contingency reserve to an upset limit of $100,000;

2. That as part of the Feasibility Study, staff review the proposed timing of the Hunt Street Detail Design capital project, currently forecasted in 2024 in the Town's Long Range Capital Forecast; and

3. That staff report back to Council or the appropriate Standing Committee with an update on the progress of the Feasibility Study prior to 2022 budget deliberation.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (4:36 p.m.)

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the May 10, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED